So “decisions” are best thought of as classical events, not quantum ones. While you might be personally unsure what choice you will eventually make, the outcome is encoded in your brain. We’re not absolutely sure about the extent to which this is true, since there’s still a lot we don’t know about the physical processes behind thinking. It’s possible that the rates of neurologically important chemical reactions can vary slightly depending on the entanglement between the different atoms involved. If that turns out to be true, there would be a sense in which your brain is a quantum computer, albeit a limited one.

At the same time, an honest Everettian admits that there will always be branches of the wave function on which quantum systems appear to have done very unlikely things. As Alice mentioned in Chapter Eight, there will be branches where I run into a wall and happen to tunnel through it, rather than bouncing off. Likewise, even if the classical approximation to my brain implies that I’m going to bet all my chips at the poker table, there is some tiny amplitude for a bunch of neurons to do unlikely things and cause me to make a snug fold. But it’s not my decision that’s causing the branching; it’s the branching that I interpret as leading to my decision.

Under the most straightforward understanding of the chemistry going on in our brains, most of our thinking has nothing to do with entanglement and branching of the wave function. We shouldn’t imagine that making a difficult decision splits the world into multiple copies, each containing a version of you that chose differently. Unless, of course, you don’t want to take responsibility, and turn your decision-making over to a quantum random-number generator.

Similarly, quantum mechanics has nothing to do with the question of free will. It’s natural to think that it might, as free will is often contrasted with determinism, the idea that the future is completely determined by the present state of the universe. After all, if the future is determined, what room is there for me to make choices? In the textbook presentation of quantum mechanics, measurement outcomes are truly random, so physics is not deterministic. Maybe that opens the door a crack for free will to sneak